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Darshana (philosophical outlook/system): this is a term applied to what Hindu *Brahmin* intellectuals consider to be the six orthodox systems of philosophy and paths to ultimate human well-being. They are ***Nyaya*** and ***Vaisheshika***, ***Samkhya*** and ***Yoga***, ***Purva Mimamsa*** and ***Vedanta***.

Dharma (natural law/social and religious duty): a fundamental Brahminical Hindu concept, *dharma* is revealed by the infallible ***Vedas***. It is the *dharma* of grass to grow and of the sun to shine. It is the *dharma* of members of the Brahmin ***caste*** to study and teach the ***Veda*** and the *dharma* of *Vaishyas* to engage in agriculture or commerce. *Dharma* would be unknown were it not taught by the ***Veda***. This ethic is thoroughly deontological. Consequentialist standards such as welfare, pleasure and pain, the biddings of conscience, divine command or the cultivation of virtuous character are all irrelevant to the determination of what is right and wrong. Values are exclusively defined by Vedic injunctions and prohibitions, and are manifested in the 'conduct of the virtuous' that derives from strict observance of the Vedic rules separating the pure from the pollutant.

Initially, the observance of *dharma* chiefly involved the performance and patronage of elaborate and expensive rituals generating prosperity (*bhoga*) and temporary enjoyments in a heaven (*svarga*). Its neglect has all sorts of negative consequences ranging from personal misfortunes to the collapse of the universe into chaos.

For the later ***Purva Mimamsaka*** theorists of ritual and social duty, the accurate performance of both the public rituals by Brahmin priests and the domestic rituals by